

Port Forwarding

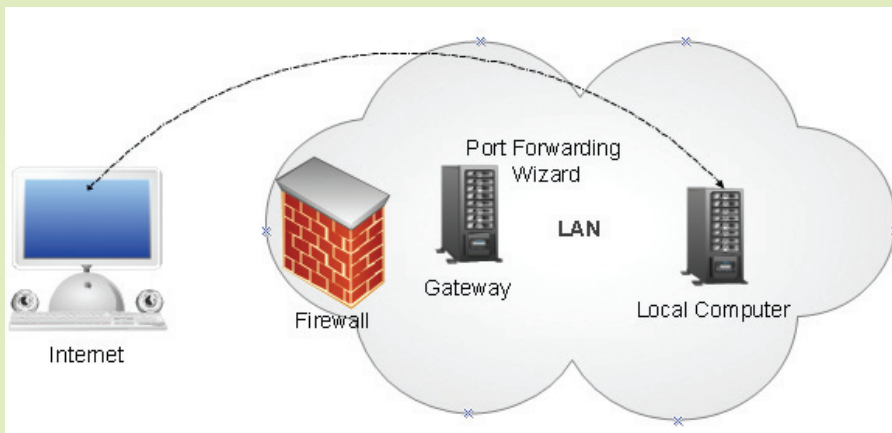
You've probably heard it used in a movie, seen the option in a software, or even read about it in Digit, and if you've found yourself what on earth that means, read on...

Before we jump into what "port forwarding" is, it's important to go over the basics. Let's start with a simple explanation of what a "port" is.

When routers, computers, or basically any communications device uses the TCP/IP protocol (the protocol the net runs on), data is sent out or received as packets with additional informa-

digit.com:80 to the server - 80 is the most common port used by web servers to serve pages to your browser.

Port forwarding can reduce the amount of time the data takes to reach the desired computer. Take, for example, online gaming, where ping times are important, as a split second could spell the difference between killing or being killed.



A look at how port forwarding essentially works

tion specifying a port number. These port numbers range from 0 to 65535 (2 to the power of 16 = 65536). This was done to prevent computers going crazy trying to figure out what data packet was for which application. So, for example, when you type thinkdigit.com into your browser, the browser actually sends the request as think-

This is also useful for, say, using the torrent network, where thousands of incoming and outgoing requests are being made, and can often hang a router or a firewall that's desperately trying to keep track of all that data. If you use "port forwarding", the router just ignores everything destined for the chosen "ports" and "forwards" it to the specified location.



Types of batteries

Alkaline: This type of battery provides life up to six times more than an ordinary zinc carbon battery. These are used in devices which require high energy drain.

Zinc Chloride: This type of battery provides relatively longer life than zinc carbon batteries. They are designed for low to medium power consumption.

Lithium ion battery: These are designed to deliver maximum power utilizing minimum amount of space. They can be fully charged in about two hours and can usually be recharged anywhere from 400 to 1,000 times.



Nickel Cadmium:

These have long service life and feature superior charge and discharge rate.

Represented as NiCd these are highly reliable and are manufactured using state of the art technology.

Lithium-ion battery for Nokia N95

What are those darn mobile app stores after all?

Ever stuck in a conversation about "cool" apps and the app stores they were downloaded from? If you find yourself lost during such conversations, then this guide to the app stores is for you.

Apple app store: This is the most popular app store which also has the maximum number of apps available for both the iPhone and the iPad. The current count is more than 3,50,000 apps, for almost everything you can think of.

Android market: The Android marketplace has the most number of free apps as compared to other platforms. Some Trade pundits believe Android has overtaken Apple's app store both in terms of popularity and the number of available apps.

Blackberry app store: Currently this is the most expensive app store on the block with apps ranging from anywhere between ₹46 to ₹4,000. If rumours are to be believed, Blackberry plans to port Android apps on their latest tablet, the BlackBerry Playbook.

Windows Phone 7 apps store: The Windows Phone 7 platform is the most recent addition to the already cluttered mobile apps store category. It currently has about 20,000 apps which some would like to argue is more than the BlackBerry apps store.